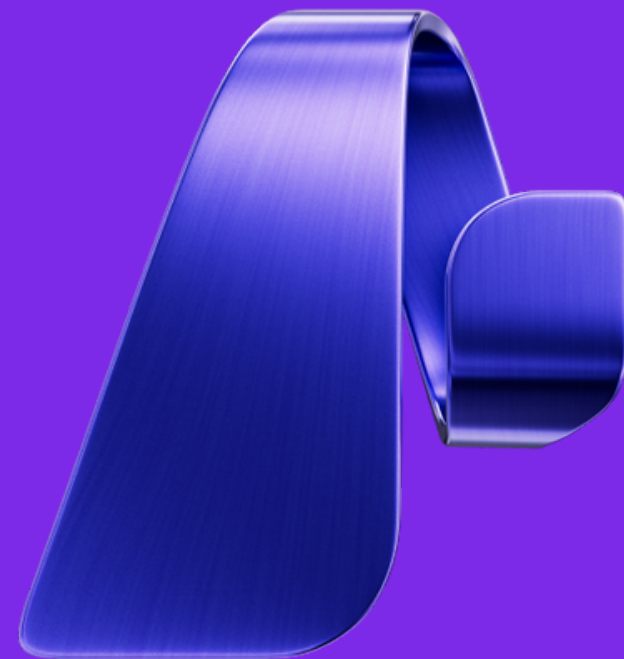
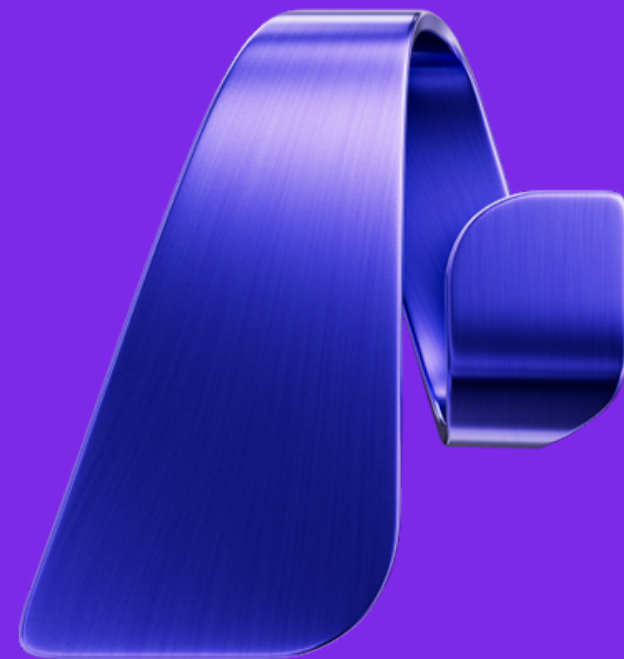


Microsoft Foundry is a unified, full-stack AI platform on Azure for building, deploying, and operating AI applications and agents.

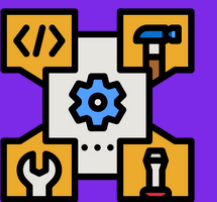


Foundry connects models, tools, and data in one modular platform – and lets you scale AI confidently at enterprise level.



What Microsoft Agent Framework actually is?

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- MAF is OpenSource, available for Python and .NET, and replaces Semantic Kernel and AutoGen.



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MAF defines:

- How agents reason
- How they manage memory and state
- How they call tools and workflows
- How multi-agent systems and agent workflows are structured



Hosted Agents ≠ Local Scripts

- Foundry agents run as managed cloud services
- The agent lives inside the Foundry project
- It handles memory, reasoning, and tool execution

Your Python app is just a client:

- Sends requests
- Receives responses

Key difference: with Foundry, orchestration happens inside the agent.

Agents vs. Raw Model Usage

Raw model API

- App builds and manages prompts
- App stores state and context
- App decides when to call tools

Agent

- App sends a task or message
- Agent reasons autonomously
- Agent chooses tools or workflows
- Agent delivers the final outcome

Microsoft Foundry SDKs

- Azure AI Projects SDK
- Microsoft Agent Framework (MAF) SDK
- OpenAI-compatible SDKs